Team 7 Charter

Purpose and Objectives

Mission Statement: To foster everybody’s learning of software development in a team setting, including technical skills, project management, and team skills.

Values and Norms

- Respect your teammates
- Do not blame or shame others
- Communicate!
    - Proactive Knowledge Sharing: Team members should offer support to peers who are facing technical blockers.
- Put in your best effort
- Take accountability for your words and actions
- Balanced Workload Distribution: We ensure that top performers are not overwhelmed by actively redistributing administrative or secondary tasks.

Project Guidelines

- Every task has one owner. When work is assigned, one person's name goes on it. That person is responsible for finishing it, asking for help if stuck, and letting the team know if something changes.
- It's okay not to know everything, but it's not okay to stay stuck silently. If you're confused about your task, say so early. Asking questions is part of the job, especially when you're learning.
- Everyone contributes to the codebase equally. No one person writes all the code. Each team member is expected to write, review, and test code, not just watch others do it.
- The team lead helps coordinate, not control. The team lead keeps the group on track and runs meetings, but doesn't make all the decisions alone. Leadership is a shared responsibility.
- Every feature should have its own branch, and all code should be merged through a pull request on GitHub.

Conflict Resolution

- Disagreements about code are normal and healthy. There's usually more than one right answer. When teammates disagree on how to do something, talk it through respectfully, don't just go silent or override each other.
- Critique the code, not the person. Saying "this function could be cleaner" is fine. Saying "you always write messy code" is not. Keep feedback about the work, not the teammate.
- If you can't resolve a disagreement in 10 minutes, ask your instructor or TA. Getting a third opinion is useful.
- Unequal workloads cause most team tension. If you feel like you're doing too much (or too little), bring it up with the team before it becomes a bigger problem. Address it early and directly.

Communication

- Respond to teammates within 24 hours. You don't have to be available all the time, but leaving messages unanswered blocks everyone else. A quick "on it" or "can't do this until Thursday" goes a long way.
- Say something if you're falling behind. Missing a deadline without warning is much harder on the team than giving a heads-up a day early. No one expects perfection — they just need to know what's happening.
- Write clear commit messages and comments. Your teammates (and future you) will read your code. A one-line note explaining why you made a change saves everyone from guessing.
- Meetings need an agenda. Before every team meeting, someone writes down what you're there to decide or discuss. Without a purpose, meetings waste time that could be spent building.